Team Chat

Implementation summary — MSW Overwatch

MetroShoe Warehouse
November 2026 · App v4.0.2

STATUS: SUCCESSFULLY IMPLEMENTED

Team Chat is a gated in-app messenger under the sidebar label Team Chat (route /chat). Allowlisted users and superadmins can start 1:1 or group threads, send text and files, see unread badges and read receipts, and get live updates through Supabase Realtime. This is staff messaging—not the AI CLI Chat assistant.

WHAT IT DOES

Team Chat gives MetroShoe staff a private messenger inside MSW Overwatch. People start 1:1 or group threads, exchange text and files, and see unread counts, typing, and online status without leaving the app. Writes go through FastAPI; browsers only read conversations they belong to so Realtime can push updates safely.

BUSINESS VALUE

Fast internal coordination without a separate chat app

Gated rollout: only the allowlist and superadmin see the feature

Live delivery for messages, unsends, and read receipts

Files stay in a private bucket; only conversation members get links

HOW A CHAT WORKS

Step	What happens
1. Open chat	Sidebar Team Chat (allowlisted emails + superadmin only). Orange badge shows unread up to 99+
2. Start a thread	New message opens the directory. Pick one person for a 1:1, or several for a group (optional title)
3. Send	Type up to 4,000 characters, attach up to 10 files (2 GB each), or both. Enter sends; Shift+Enter is a new line
4. Stay in sync	New messages, unsends, and read receipts arrive live. Typing shows while someone is composing. Online status uses app presence heartbeats
5. Clean up	Sender can Unsend their own message. Group members can Leave. Direct chats cannot be left; each pair keeps one thread

CORE FEATURES

Feature	Behavior
1:1 chats	One thread per pair via a unique direct_key. Creating again reopens the same conversation
Groups	Two or more other people, optional title (80 characters). Up to 50 members total. Leave removes membership
Unread & Seen	Per-conversation and sidebar totals. Opening a thread marks it read. Own last message shows Seen / Seen by … when others catch up
Attachments	One file per message row. Images and short videos preview inline when small enough; larger files show a download card

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Unsend	Clears the body, sets deleted, removes the file from storage, and updates the conversation preview

LIMITS

Limit	Value
Message body	4,000 characters
Group title	80 characters
Group size	50 members (including you)
File size	2 GB per file (private team-chat-files bucket)
Files per send	10 at a time in the composer
Message page size	50 by default (API allows 1–100)
Signed preview / download	1 hour preview · 5 minutes download

API SURFACE

All routes require app access plus Team Chat eligibility. Missing tables return 503 with a hint to run the migration. Create, leave, and unsend are audited; routine send and mark-read traffic is not.

Area	API (under /api/v1/messenger)
Directory & unread	GET /users · GET /unread-count
Conversations	GET/POST /conversations · GET /conversations/{id} · leave & mark-read
Messages	List with before/after paging · send text/attachment · DELETE /messages/{id} (unsend)
Files	Mint signed upload · discard failed upload · signed view/download for members only

WHO CAN USE IT

User	Access
Allowlisted emails	sunshine@, stephanie@, paolo@, paulo@, johnbernard@ (metroshoewarehouse.com)
Superadmin	Full Team Chat access; appears in the directory for others who can chat
All other users	No sidebar link; route and API return blocked / redirect

DATABASE SCRIPT

Run this once in the Supabase SQL Editor. The API uses the service role for writes. Authenticated browsers get SELECT only on threads they belong to (via messenger_is_member), which is what Realtime needs. Anon has no access.

Script	Adds
create_messenger_chat.sql	Conversations, members, messages, attachment columns, private team-chat-files bucket, RLS, Realtime publication

KEY RULES

Only allowlisted users and superadmins can open Team Chat or appear in the new-message directory

Each pair of people shares one direct thread; groups are separate and can be left

Browsers never write chat tables directly—FastAPI owns creates, sends, reads, unsends, and leave

Attachment links are short-lived and membership-checked; outsiders get 404

ROLLOUT CHECKLIST

- Run create_messenger_chat.sql in the Supabase SQL Editor. Confirm the private team-chat-files bucket and a project upload limit of at least 2 GB
- Confirm Team Chat appears in the sidebar only for the allowlist and superadmin
- Start a 1:1: send text, confirm the other user's unread badge and live delivery
- Open the thread: mark-read clears unread; Seen appears on the sender's last message
- Create a group with a title, send a file under 2 GB, preview or download as a member, confirm an outsider cannot open it
- Unsend a message with an attachment: body clears, file is removed, preview becomes Message unsent
- Leave a group (membership gone). Confirm a direct chat cannot be left
- Optional: set TEAM_CHAT_ALLOWED_EMAILS on the API. Empty string opens the API to all active users—update the frontend allowlist separately for UI parity

NOTES FOR LEADERSHIP

Shipped on web / desktop app version 4.0.2

Route /chat · Sidebar Team Chat · API /api/v1/messenger/*

Same allowlist pattern as FBA Order Checker / FBA Box Contents. Does not replace CLI Chat (AI assistant), email, or external messengers